

Minimi Knit Design

Luminous Summer

by Cristina T. Ghirlanda

Luminous Summer is a simple tee worked from the top down. It has minimalistic finishing with a row of eyelets delicately framing the face. It has a unique placement of short rows that shapes the neck without disrupting the neckline. This cropped tee uses very little yarn, making it the perfect project to indulge in exquisite yarns.

Luminous Summer is graded with inclusive sizing in mind, designed to fit actual bust sizes from 76 cm / 30 inches to 168 cm / 66 inches. Measurements are given in both cm and inches.

Materials

Yarn

DK weight

Shown here:

Orchidean Luxury Yarns Luminous DK (100% Silk; 225 m / 246 yds, 100 g / 3.53 oz skein; Color Pale Teal: 2 (2, 3, 3, 3) {3, 3, 4, 4, 4} skeins)

Yardage: 375 (425, 475, 525, 575) {620, 685, 740, 785, 855} m / 410 (465, 520, 575, 630) {680, 750, 810, 860, 935} yds, including 10% allowance

Notions

Stitch marker; waste yarn; yarn needle

Needles

- ❖ 4.5 mm / US 7 circular needle of length 60-100 cm / 24-40 inches, depending on your size; adjust needle size if necessary to obtain gauge.
- ❖ 3.75 mm / US 5 needles in your preferred style for small circumference knitting in the round, for the armhole edgings

Gauge

17 sts and 22 rows = 10 cm / 4 inches in stockinette stitch on larger needle worked in the round, blocked.



Sizes

Size 1 (2, 3, 4, 5) {6, 7, 8, 9, 10}

This garment is intended to be worn with about 12-18 cm / 4 $\frac{3}{4}$ -7 inches positive ease.

Shown in size 1, modeled with 18 cm / 7 inches of positive ease.

Finished Measurements

Bust circumference: 94.5 (104.5, 113.5, 123.5, 133.5) {142, 152, 161, 171, 180} cm / 37 $\frac{1}{4}$ (41, 44 $\frac{1}{2}$, 48 $\frac{1}{2}$, 52 $\frac{1}{2}$) {56, 60, 63 $\frac{1}{2}$, 67 $\frac{1}{4}$, 70 $\frac{3}{4}$ } inches

How to choose your size: Measure a sweater in a similar style in your closet or add the amount of desired ease to your actual bust measurement, pick a size closest to that number. For between sizes, choose the smaller size. For example, if you want 15 cm / 6 inches of positive ease and your bust measurement is 99 cm / 39 inches, you should pick size 3.

Required Skills

Increases, knitting in the round



Abbreviations

BO - bind off

BOR - beginning of round

CO - cast on

inc('d) - increase(d)

k - knit

k2tog - knit two together

m1L - With right needle, lift the strand between the stitch just worked and the next stitch from back to front and place it on left needle, knit into the back of the new stitch.

m1R - With right needle, lift the strand between the stitch just worked and the next stitch from front to back and place it on left needle, knit into the front of the new stitch.

p - purl

pm - place marker

RLI - insert right needle into the purl bump on the WS of next stitch, knit from there (*i.e. you are knitting into the right leg of the stitch below the next stitch*)

RS - right side

sm - slip marker

ssk - slip 2 sts individually as if to knit, then knit them together through the back loops

ssp - slip 2 sts individually as if to knit. Return them to the left needle, then purl them together through the back loops

st(s) - stitch(es)

WS - wrong side

yo - yarn over

[...] - repeat as directed

Stitch Guide

Short Row Turn: You can use any short-row technique. The sample uses yarn over short rows, which is worked as follows: Work as instructed to the turning point. Turn work. (*Alternatively, see video tutorial here <https://youtu.be/I17gPsK7c1Q>*)

- ❖ If the first stitch is a purl stitch, make a normal yarn over on the right needle (*i.e. wrapping the yarn from the front towards the back of the right needle, bring yarn forward and then purl as usual*).

- ❖ If the first stitch is a knit stitch, make a backwards yarn over on the right needle (*i.e. wrapping the yarn from back towards the front of the right needle, bring yarn back and then knit as usual*).
- ❖ On subsequent short rows, work the yarn over together with the stitch following it using k2tog on a RS row or ssp on a WS row. It won't be mentioned in the pattern.

Directions

Yoke

With larger needle, use the long-tail method (*or your preferred stretchy cast on*) to CO 87 (87, 90, 90, 93) {93, 93, 96, 96, 96} sts. Join and begin working in the round, being careful not to twist stitches. Place BOR marker.

Knit 5 rounds.

Please check that the piece can be stretched to a circumference of at least 58 cm / 22 $\frac{3}{4}$ inches or that your head can pass through it with ease.

Next round (Eyelets round): [K3, yo] around – 116 (116, 120, 120, 124) {124, 124, 128, 128, 128} sts.

Nexn round: Knit around.

Next round: [K3, k1 through back loop] around.

Continue to work even in Stockinette stitch until piece measures 5.5 cm / 2 $\frac{1}{4}$ inches from CO.

Next round (First Increase Round): [K4, RLI] around – 145 (145, 150, 150, 155) {155, 155, 160, 160, 160} sts.

Work even until piece measures 8.5 cm / 3 $\frac{1}{2}$ inches from CO.

Next round (Second Increase Round):

- ❖ **Sizes 1, 3:** [K5, RLI] around.
- ❖ **Size 2:** K3, RLI, [k5, RLI] 14 times, k2, RLI, [k5, RLI] 14 times.
- ❖ **Size 4:** *K3, RLI, [k4, RLI] 18 times **; repeat from * to **.
- ❖ **Size 5:** [K2, RLI] twice, [k3, RLI] 24 times, [k2, RLI] twice, [k3, RLI] 25 times.
- ❖ **Size 6:** K6, [k4, RLI] 18 times, k5, RLI, [k4, RLI] 18 times.
- ❖ **Size 7:** K3, RLI, [k3, RLI] 25 times, k2, RLI, [k3, RLI] 25 times.



❖ **Sizes 8, 9, 10:** K1, [K3, RLI] around.

❖ 174 (175, 180, 188, 208) {192, 207, 213, 213, 213} sts total.

Work even until piece measures 11 cm / $4\frac{1}{4}$ inches from CO.

Next round (Third Increase Round): [K6 (5, 4, 4, 4) {4, 3, 3, 3, 3}, RLI] around – 203 (210, 225, 235, 260) {240, 276, 284, 284, 284} sts.

Work even until piece measures 14.5 cm / $5\frac{3}{4}$ inches from CO.

Next round (Fourth Increase Round):

❖ **Size 1:** K3, RLI, [k6, RLI] 16 times, k2, RLI, [k6, RLI] 17 times.

❖ **Sizes - (2, 3, -, -) {6, -, -, -, -}:** [K- (5, 5, -, -) {4, -, -, -, -}, RLI] around.

❖ **Size 4:** K2, RLI, [k4, RLI] 29 times, k1, RLI, [k4, RLI] 29 times.

❖ **Sizes - (-, -, -, 5) {-, 7, -, 9, -}:** *K2, [k4, RLI] - (-, -, -, 32) {-, 34, -, 35, -} times; repeat from *.

❖ **Size 8:** *K1, RLI, [k3, RLI] 47 times; repeat from *.

❖ **Size 10:** *K1, [k3, RLI] 47 times; repeat from *.

❖ 238 (252, 270, 295, 324) {300, 344, 380, 354, 378} sts total.

Work even until piece measures 18 cm / 7 inches from CO.

Next round (Fifth Increase Round): [K7 (6, 5, 5, 6) {3, 4, 5, 3, 3}, RLI] around – 272 (294, 324, 354, 378) {400, 430, 456, 472, 504} sts.

Continue to work even in Stockinette stitch until piece measures 24 (25.5, 26.5, 27.5, 28) {29.5, 30.5, 31, 32, 33} cm / $9\frac{1}{2}$ (10, $10\frac{1}{2}$, $10\frac{3}{4}$, 11) { $11\frac{1}{2}$, 12, $12\frac{1}{4}$, $12\frac{1}{2}$, 13} inches from CO.

Note: Use a different color for the side markers so that you can easily distinguish them from the BOR marker.

Next round (Divide for Body): [K83 (91, 99, 108, 115) {123, 132, 140, 146, 154} for body, transfer next 53 (56, 63, 69, 74) {77, 83, 88, 90, 98} sts to waste yarn for sleeve, CO 2 (3, 3, 3, 5) {5, 5, 5, 8, 8} underarm stitches (placing a side marker at approximately the middle of the underarm)] twice – 170 (188, 204, 222, 240) {256, 274, 290, 308, 324} sts. Join in the round and begin working the Lower Body.

Lower Body

Knit 2 rounds, then begin short row shaping (so that the front neck drops lower than the back neck).

Short Row Shaping

Short row 1 (RS): Knit to side marker, sm, short row turn.

Short row 2 (WS): Sm, purl to side marker, sm, short row turn.

Short row 3 (RS): Knit to 5 sts beyond previous turning position, short row turn.

Short row 4 (WS): Purl to 5 sts beyond previous turning position, short row turn.

Work Short rows 3-4 twice more.

Next short row (RS): Knit to 6 sts beyond previous turning position, short row turn.

Next short row (WS): Purl to 6 sts beyond previous turning position, short row turn.

Resume working in the round, resolving the first yarn over together with the stitch following it using k2tog and resolve the second yarn over by working it together with the stitch before it using ssk.

Work even in Stockinette stitch until piece measures 8 cm / $3\frac{1}{4}$ inches from the underarm.

Next round (Increase Round): [Knit to last stitch before side marker, m1R, k1, sm, k1, m1L] twice, knit to end of round – 4 sts inc'd; 174 (192, 208, 226, 244) {260, 278, 294, 312, 328} sts.

Work even until piece measures 17.5 cm / 7 inches from the underarm or your desired length minus 1.5 cm / $\frac{5}{8}$ inches.

Change to smaller needle.

Next round: [K1 through back loop, p1] around.

Work last round twice more.

Next round: [BO 1 knitwise, BO 1 purlwise] around.

Cut yarn.

Armhole Edgings

Note: Both edgings are worked identically.

Note: See video <https://youtu.be/rqI0F01d4rc> on to how to prevent holes while picking up stitches.

Transfer the 53 (56, 63, 69, 74) {77, 83, 88, 90, 98} sleeve stitches onto larger needle (used as spare needle). With smaller needle for small circumference knitting and RS facing, join yarn at the middle of the underarm, pick up and knit 1 (1, 1, 1, 2) {2, 2, 2, 4, 4} sts, knit across sleeve stitches, pick up and knit 1 (2, 2, 2, 3) {3, 3, 3, 4, 4} sts, pm – 55 (59, 66, 72, 79) {82, 88, 93, 98, 106} sts.



Next round:

❖ **Sizes 1 (2, -, -, 5) {-, -, 8, -, -}**: K2tog, p1, [k1, p1] around – 54 (58, -, -, 78) {-, -, 92, -, -} sts.

❖ **Sizes - (-, 3, 4, -) {6, 7, -, 9, 10}**: [K1, p1] around.

Next round: Knit around.

Next round: [BO 1 knitwise, BO 1 purlwise] around.

Cut yarn.

Repeat for the other armhole edging.

Finishing

Weave in ends. Block to schematic measurements (*see Appendix*).

About the Designer

Cristina lives in northern Tuscany with her sons, husband and two cats. She strives to design timeless knitwear, using elements from both classic and contemporary designs. She writes uncomplicated patterns that are easy to follow. To find more about her designs, check out her website MinimiKnitDesign.com. You can also find her as Minimi on Ravelry or as @MinimiKnitDesign on Instagram.



If you share your project on social media, please tag it with #luminousSummer #minimiknitdesign @minimiknitdesign. I would love to see what you make!

Acknowledgments and Credits

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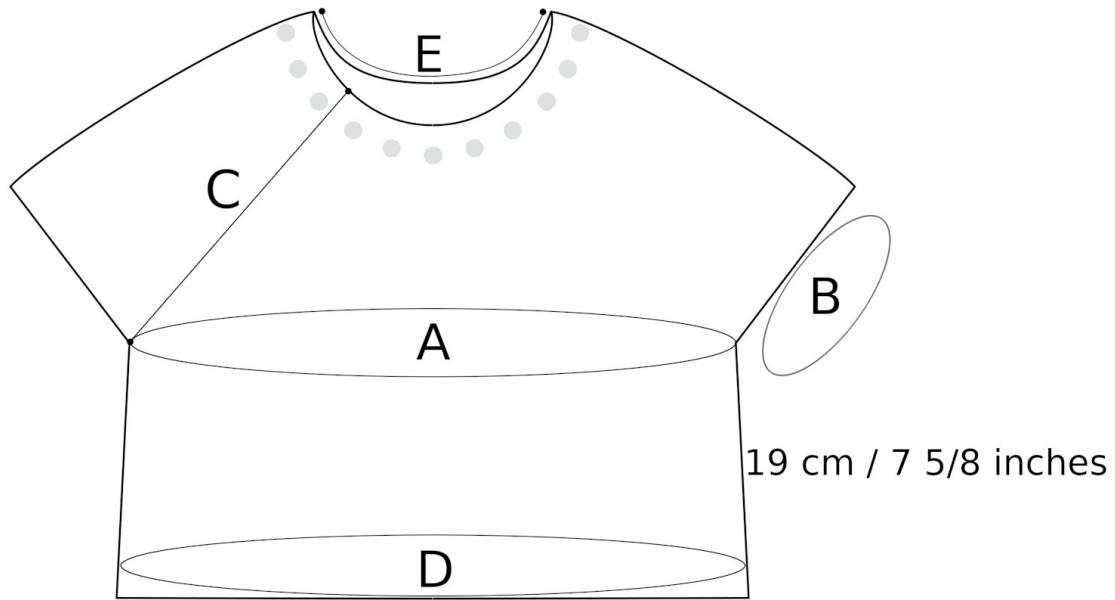
This pattern is a collaboration with Orchidean Luxury Yarn.

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Schematic



Size		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
A. Bust circumference*	cm	94.5	104.5	113.5	123.5	133.5	142	152	161	171	180
	inch	37 1/4	41	44 1/2	48 1/2	52 1/2	56	60	63 1/2	67 1/4	70 3/4
B. Sleeve circumference	cm	26	28	32	35	37.5	39.5	42.5	44.5	47.5	51
	inch	10 1/4	11	12 1/2	13 3/4	14 3/4	15 1/2	16 3/4	17 1/2	18 3/4	20 1/4
C. Yoke depth	cm	24	25.5	26.5	27.5	28	29.5	30.5	31	32	33
	inch	9 1/2	10	10 1/2	10 3/4	11	11 1/2	12	12 1/4	12 1/2	13
D. Hem circumference	cm	96.5	106.5	116	125.5	135.5	145	154.5	164	173.5	183
	inch	38	42	45 3/4	49 1/2	53 1/4	57	60 3/4	64 1/2	68 1/4	72 1/4
E. Half neck circumference (measured along the curve)	cm	25.5	25.5	26.5	26.5	27.5	27.5	27.5	28	28	28
	inch	10	10	10 1/2	10 1/2	10 3/4	10 3/4	10 3/4	11	11	11

* The bust circumference is not calculated directly from the stitch count due to the way the front is shaped by the short rows.



Appendix

How to block a sweater

The effect of blocking a sweater is similar to that of ironing but without the heat. It evens out stitches and makes the sweater look more polished. It also keeps edges from rolling. It is a step that you definitely do not want to skip. Here I describe how I block a sweater and it does not mean to be THE only way to do it.

Step 1. Soak the sweater in tap water. I do not heat water nor add detergent.



Step 2. *Gently* squeeze out excess water and put it on a dry towel.



Step 3. Roll the sweater up in the towel to absorb as much water as possible. You may need to use more than one towel, depending on your size and yarn fiber.



Step 4. Lay it on a flat surface. If you have a blocking mat, by all means use it, otherwise any flat surface will do. I use a mesh hanging dryer.



Step 5. Shape the sweater properly, making sure that it matches all the schematic measurements.



Step 6. Ideally, air dry the sweater. In reality things never get dry where I live except in summer. So when it is almost dry, I put it directly over the radiator to make sure that it is completely dry.

